

Write to the Editor

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Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. You must include your complete address in all communication.

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Inbox

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH

made till date in the next issue or in a forthcoming issue.

Himanshu Pant
Pithoragarh, Uttarakhand

Dear Himanshu,
Naturally, we're glad our *Fast Track* series is being appreciated. We'll certainly be providing all of them again in one of our future issues, as we did in January 2006.

— Associate Editor

Call from Mauritius

I'm a BBM final year student studying in Bangalore. Actually, I'm a foreign student, from Mauritius. I would like to congratulate your team for all the efforts they've put in to create such a good magazine. My stay in India will soon be over, and I've been buying your magazine since around July of last year. I've gotten hooked! I keep waiting for each next issue. The problem is, back home in Mauritius, I won't be able to get your magazine; is there a subscription scheme for me to apply to? Please help!!

Ponnusami Vishwen Pazani
Bangalore

Dear Ponnusami,
Thank you for the praise you've heaped upon us! We appreciate your efforts in writing to us on such a congratulatory note. Few people take the pain to praise and appreciate others—you're one of them. As for a subscription in Mauritius, unfortunately, we do not have an international subscription scheme as of now. But you can tell your friends to mail you the DVD, which contains the soft copies. (Almost every six months, we give out the past 12 issues of *Digit*).

— Associate Editor

Troubleshooting made easy

First off, let me thank you for the wonderful issues that you bring out each month. I have some requirements regarding my career. I am a second-year engineering student (IT) from Gwalior. I have to submit a project catering to Industrial needs. I want some ideas regarding the same either in hardware or software or Web-based. If you do have some ideas, please let me know via e-mail: I cannot wait for the next issue. I want the coding too, in case of software (preferably programming in C++). I also needed information about companies who take in freshers for summer training in their firms.

Now regarding the magazine, this June, it will be your fifth anniversary. I'm

congratulating you in advance. You will be giving out many goodies, so I want that you should give a full mission-based game—like *Tomb Raider* or *Resident Evil*.

I want to thank you for the *Fast Track to Troubleshooting your PC*, with the help of which now I can solve 99 per cent of my problems.

Sandeep Ghosh
Gwalior

Dear Sandeep,
We're always listening to our readers—we've already responded to your letter via e-mail. Regarding what to give out with the June issue, we haven't finalised yet, but rest assured, you will like the contents.

— Associate Editor

Linux Lover

I have been a *Digit* fan for the past four years, and I've seen the magazine growing at a great pace. I owe you guys a lot for my tech knowledge. I liked the April edition a lot. The *Fast Track to Linux* was something I was expecting for a long time. Having experimented with Linux few times and ending up with some problems, I still never lost interest in Linux, but I felt something was missing. After I read the *Fast Track*, the void was filled, as it were, and I'll now start experimenting with Linux again. The article on gaming was also good.

I am aware that Jasubhai publishes a gaming magazine called SKOAR!, which provides posters of games. Can't you, too, provide game posters, at least in special editions? Can you also provide a *Fast Track* on PHP and other such commonly-used scripting languages? It will be helpful to most *Digit* readers, because even if the number of developers is comparatively low, there are lots of people with blogs. I am sure it will help them too. Thanks!

Sujith Tom Abraham
Kerala

Dear Sujith,
We have already considered a *Fast Track* on programming and scripting languages—we also think it's a pretty good idea. As far as game posters are concerned, as I said last month, we are definitely mulling over it and trying to get the official consent from some game developers for it.

— Associate Editor

Broadband Blues

Firstly, hats off to a great magazine! I have always been an avid reader, especially of the editorial and feedback, which discuss relevant and pertinent issues. I would like to highlight an important issue pertaining to BSNL broadband subscribers. BSNL is following an incorrect procedure for billing its broadband subscribers. I recently bore the brunt of the same in the month of February, when I was over-billed. BSNL follows a practice that is so inherently wrong that I wonder why no one has realised it yet... I guess you know that BSNL offers you free downloads between 0200 and 0800 hours.

But they don't bill you for the actual time of the download, even if you schedule your downloads for between those time points—but if you stay online for 24 hours, they bill you for 24 hours.

Say I log in at 0000 Monday, and log out at 0000 Tuesday. I schedule my downloads for six hours, between 0200 and 0800 Monday. I download 240 MB in the six hours. BSNL says only $240/24 \times 6 = 60$ MB is free, and they CHARGE SUBSCRIBERS for 180 MB. This is shocking, and if this were the US or any other country, it would have resulted in a class action suit. This method must be netting them crores of revenue from unaware, innocent and policy-abiding customers. This needs to be stopped, and if necessary, we should pursue BSNL to come clean.

So much for "broadband"—looks like BSNL still follows the dial-up mentality.

Your feedback is welcome, and I hope you publish this so that other readers are aware and get together to correct this unfair practice for the overall benefit of everyone involved.

Abhishek Banerjee

Dear Abhishek,
We know that broadband billing is unfair in the case of some companies, and just so they listen to you (and to other readers who have the same complaint but didn't write in), we're making yours the Letter of the Month. We hope BSNL sits up and takes notice, possibly resolving your issue and/or clarifying what is going on.

— Associate Editor